Instructor
Jacob Levman

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Office Location
Physical Sciences Building (PSB) 1020

Office Hours
Monday 1:30-2:20
Tuesday 12:30-1:20
Tuesday 1:30-2:20
Wednesday 11:30-12:20
Wednesday 12:30-1:20
Friday 11:30-12:20

Class Time and Location
MULH 4022
Monday 4:00-5:15
Wednesday 2:30-3:45

Course TA
Xuchen Guo
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ST. FRANCIS XAVIER UNIVERSITY

Subject Name: CSCI 584 Graduate Seminar

Course Overview

This seminar course prepares graduates for industry or academia by developing knowledge and skills that will be applicable in a variety of professional contexts. Among these skills will be professional communication with industry and non-industry audiences, social and ethical issues in the field, grant and proposal writing, job search skills, research skills, and current innovations in research. The course is facilitated by computer science faculty members and includes presentations by invited experts. Pass/Fail. Three credits.

Additional Course Information
This course will involve the use of state-of-the-art AI coding agent assistant software for the creation of fun and novel technologies. Students will complete one project, with the help of AI coding agents, focused on any computational task.

Learning Objectives
By the end of this course, you will be able to:

- Use an AI coding agent to complete a fun, novel, and/or interesting computer science project.
- Present your technical/project work clearly to the classroom.
- Learn from a wide array of researchers and service providers.
- Demonstrate your comprehension of the materials presented in class.

Evaluation

This is a pass/fail course. Students will be required to create a one-page summary of each lecture / seminar session and upload it to moodle by the end of the day. Students will also pursue an AI-coding

agent assisted project of their own choosing, and present the results of that work near the end of the course.

Class Participation and Attendance: Students are expected to not only attend class, but to actively participate in the course materials being presented and/or discussed. Asking thoughtful and pertinent questions about course content and provoking discussions add value to the class. Daily summaries are required. The professor will also take attendance sporadically, non-attendance will penalize your final grade.

Method of Instruction

The course will include lectures on relevant materials coupled with classroom discussions, largely focused on course content.

Course Schedule

The course will begin with outlining the parameters of the course projects, followed by a series of guest lectures in a seminar format. We will conclude with a series of student presentations.

Course Materials & Resources

There are no required texts for this course. In lieu of a textbook, students are strongly encouraged to try out paid coding agent models (yes coding agent assistance can be obtained for free, but those models tend to be inferior). ChatGPT with codex, and Claude with Claude Code (paid subscriptions) are recommended. All students will need access to computational resources. This includes a traditional computer. A GPU is helpful in many projects.

Method of Evaluation

Summaries of each lecture, and assessment of your AI coding assistant software project will form the basis of your pass/fail grade.

Attendance Policy
There is a **strong correlation between class attendance and class performance** (students that attend class regularly tend to do better). Students are responsible for all material covered in class.

Students are responsible for all announcements made in class

- If the Registrar's Office schedules us a final exam in December after classes end, we will not be needing it.

Learning Environment: Everyone learns more effectively in a respectful, safe and equitable learning environment, free from discrimination and harassment. I invite you to work with me to create a classroom space—both real and virtual—that fosters and promotes values of human dignity, equity, non-discrimination and respect for diversity. These values and practices are in accord with the StFX Discrimination and Harassment Policy which can be found at http://www.mystfx.ca/campus/stu-serv/equity/. Please feel free to talk to me about your questions or concerns about equity in our classroom or in the StFX community in general. If I cannot answer your questions or help you address your concerns, I encourage you to talk to the Chair/Coordinator of the Department/Program.

These course materials are designed for use in CSCI 584 at StFX University and are the property of the instructor, unless otherwise stated by the instructor. Copying this material for distribution, online posting, or selling of this material to third parties without permission is subject to Canadian Copyright Law and is strictly prohibited.

Information about requesting an accommodation at STFX

If you have a disability and would like to request accommodations, please contact the instructor during the first week of the semester so that your accommodations may be provided in a timely manner. Centre for Accessible Learning (CAL) provides assistance in determining and facilitating appropriate accommodations for students with verified disabilities.

TRAMBLE CENTER FOR ACCESSIBLE LEARNING. The Tramble Center for Accessible Learning welcomes students with documented permanent disabilities and offers them a student-centered program of support. Located in Room 108 of the Angus L MacDonald Library, new and returning students meet with program staff to discuss options for support. Deadline for registering with the Center is two weeks prior to the end of classes each semester and 3 Business Days' notice is required for booking all accommodated tests and exams. To book an appointment please use the following link:

stfxcal.mywconline.com

Phone 902.867.5349 Email: tramble@stfx.ca